

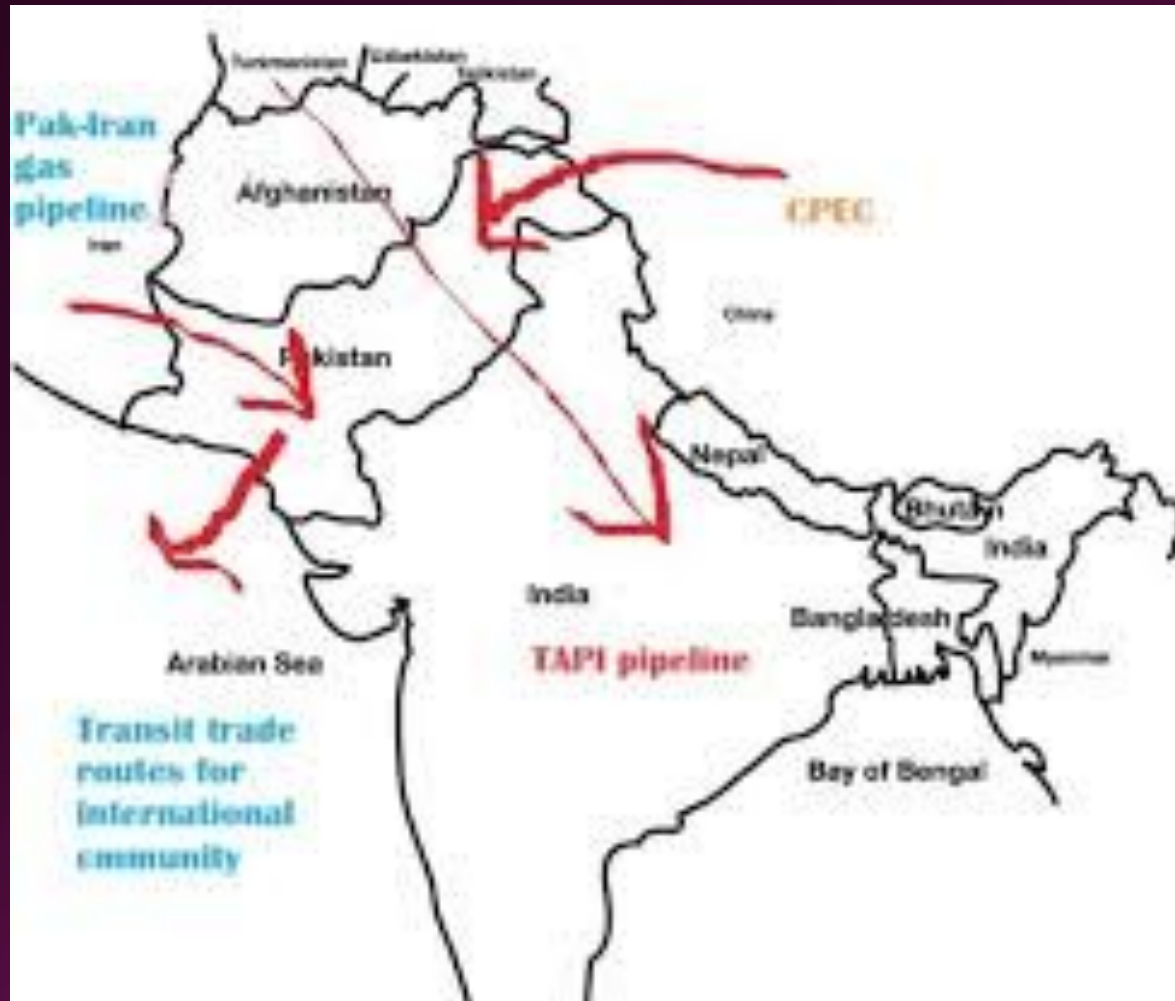
Pakistan's Relations with the Big Powers, Neighbours & Muslim World

CLO 01, 02 & 03

This Lecture Includes the Following topics:

- **Geostrategic Importance of Pakistan**
- **Pakistan Relations with Great Powers**
- **Pakistan & its neighbors; India & Afghanistan**
- **Pakistan Relations with the Muslim World**

What is GEO STRATEGIC IMPORTANCE OF PAKISTAN?



- Pakistan's strategic importance lies in its geographical position at the intersection of South Asia, Central Asia, and the Middle East.
- It shares borders with critical nations, including Afghanistan, China, India, and Iran, making it a pivotal player in regional stability, trade routes, and global power dynamics, particularly in matters of security and energy interests.

Pakistan's External Borders

1. India – to the east

- Shares a long and historically significant border.

2. Afghanistan – to the northwest

- Separated by the **Durand Line**, a historically disputed boundary.

3. Iran – to the west (Pakistan Iran Barrier)

- Shares cultural and trade ties with Pakistan.

4. China – to the northeast

- Connected through the **Karakoram Highway** and a strong strategic relationship.

5. Arabian Sea – to the south

- Provides Pakistan with access to sea trade through ports like **Karachi** and **Gwadar**.

The Strategic Importance of Pakistan: A Geo-strategic Nexus

- **Geopolitical Significance**

- 1- Bridge between South Asia and Central Asia
- 2- Balancing Power Dynamics

Pakistan connects the oil-rich Middle East with energy-hungry South and East Asia, making it a vital transit country.

- **Proximity to Major Powers:** Shares borders with China, India, Afghanistan, and Iran, placing it at the heart of several major regional power dynamics.
- **Access to the Arabian Sea:** The coastline along the Arabian Sea provides crucial sea trade routes and access to warm waters year-round, enhancing naval and trade capabilities.

- **Economic Significance**

- 1- Trade and Energy Corridor
- 2- Agriculture and Resource Potential

- **Security Significance**

- 1- Counterterrorism Efforts
- 2- Nuclear Arsenal

- **Regional Dynamics of Pakistan**

- 1- Relationship with India
- 2- Role in Afghanistan
- 3- Relationship with Iran

- **Pakistan's Global Partnerships**

United States-Pakistan
Collaboration

China-Pakistan Friendship

- **Strategic Significance and Challenges for Pakistan**

1- Security Concerns

2- Terrorism

3- Geopolitical Rivalry

4- Economic Development

5- Geopolitical Buffer Zone

6- Security and Defense

Considerations

Opportunities and Benefits of Pakistan's Strategic Importance

1- China-Pakistan Economic Corridor (CPEC)

2- Regional Connectivity

3- Counterterrorism Cooperation

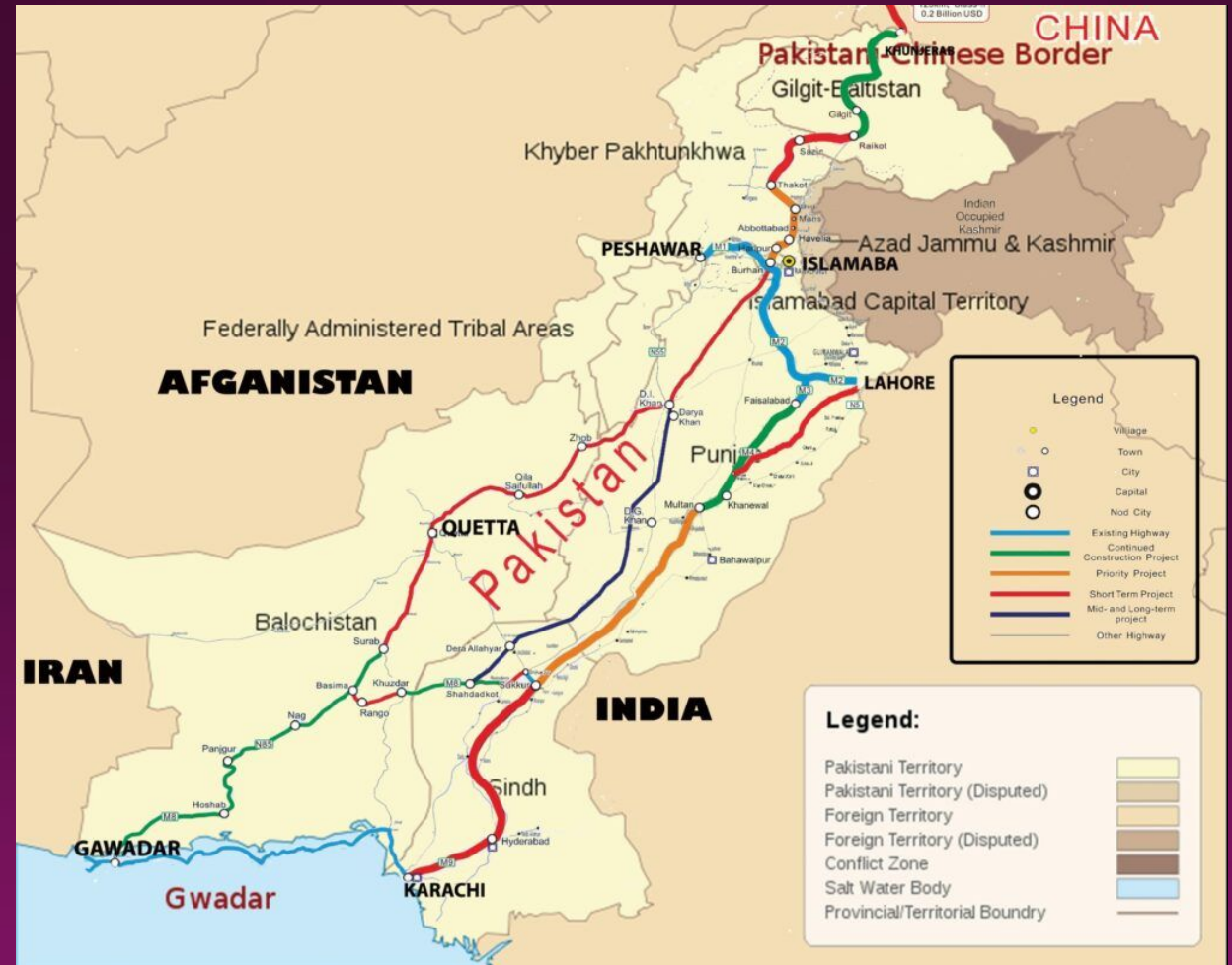
4- Diplomacy and Reconciliation

5- Agricultural Significance

6. Cultural and Historical Crossroads

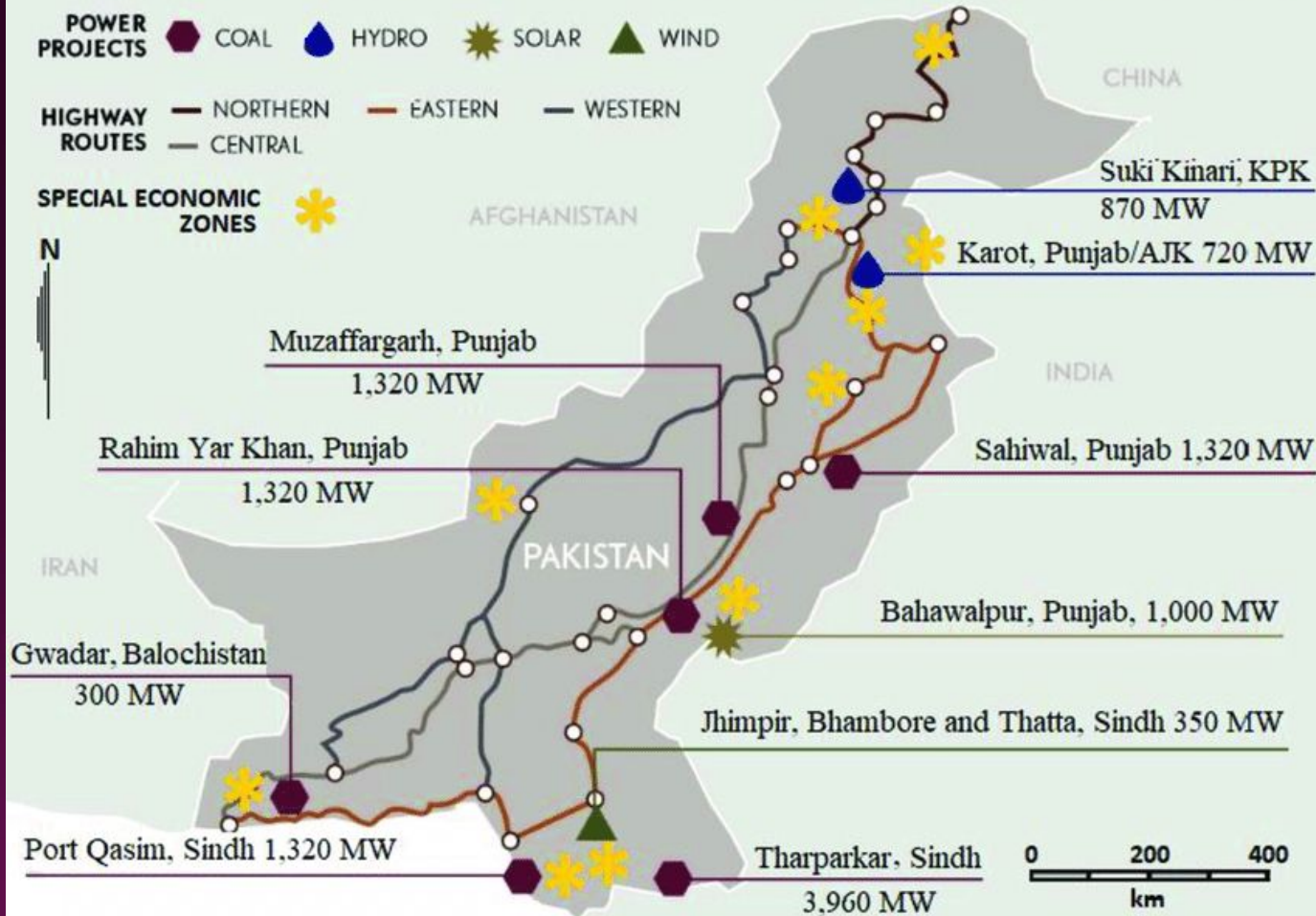
China-Pakistan Economic Corridor (CPEC)

- **Gateway to Central Asia and China:** Gwadar Port in Balochistan connects Western China to the Arabian Sea, reducing China's dependence on the Strait of Malacca.
- **Economic Lifeline:** CPEC enhances Pakistan's infrastructure and energy sectors, increasing its geopolitical value for China and the wider Belt and Road Initiative.



(China-Pakistan Economic Corridor)

Major Projects of China-Pakistan Economic Corridor

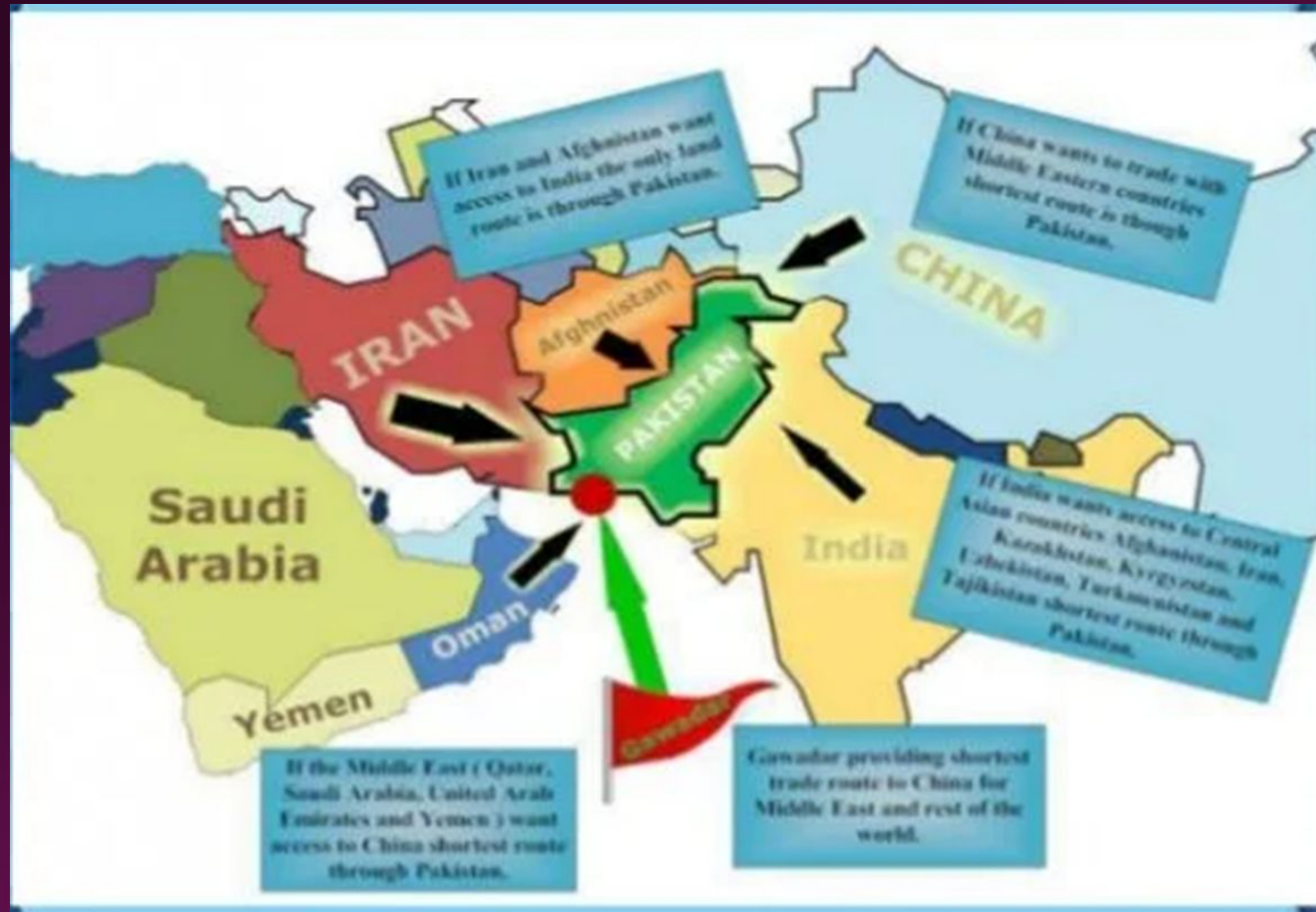


- A collection of infrastructure projects that form part of China's Belt and Road Initiative (BRI).
- Runs from **Kashgar** in **China's Xinjiang province** to **Gwadar Port** in Pakistan's Balochistan.

Geographic Significance for Pakistan:

- **North-South Connectivity:** Uses Pakistan's geography to create a **logistical spine** connecting China to the Arabian Sea.
- **Gwadar Port:** Pakistan's **deep-water port**, strategically located near the **Strait of Hormuz** (a global oil chokepoint), is the **centerpiece of CPEC**.
- **Karakoram Highway:** One of the world's highest paved roads, traversing **Gilgit-Baltistan**, shows how even the rugged geography is being harnessed for connectivity.
- **Strategic Centrality:** Positions Pakistan as a **trade and energy corridor** between the Middle East, Central Asia, China, and the global maritime routes.

Geopolitical Buffer Zone



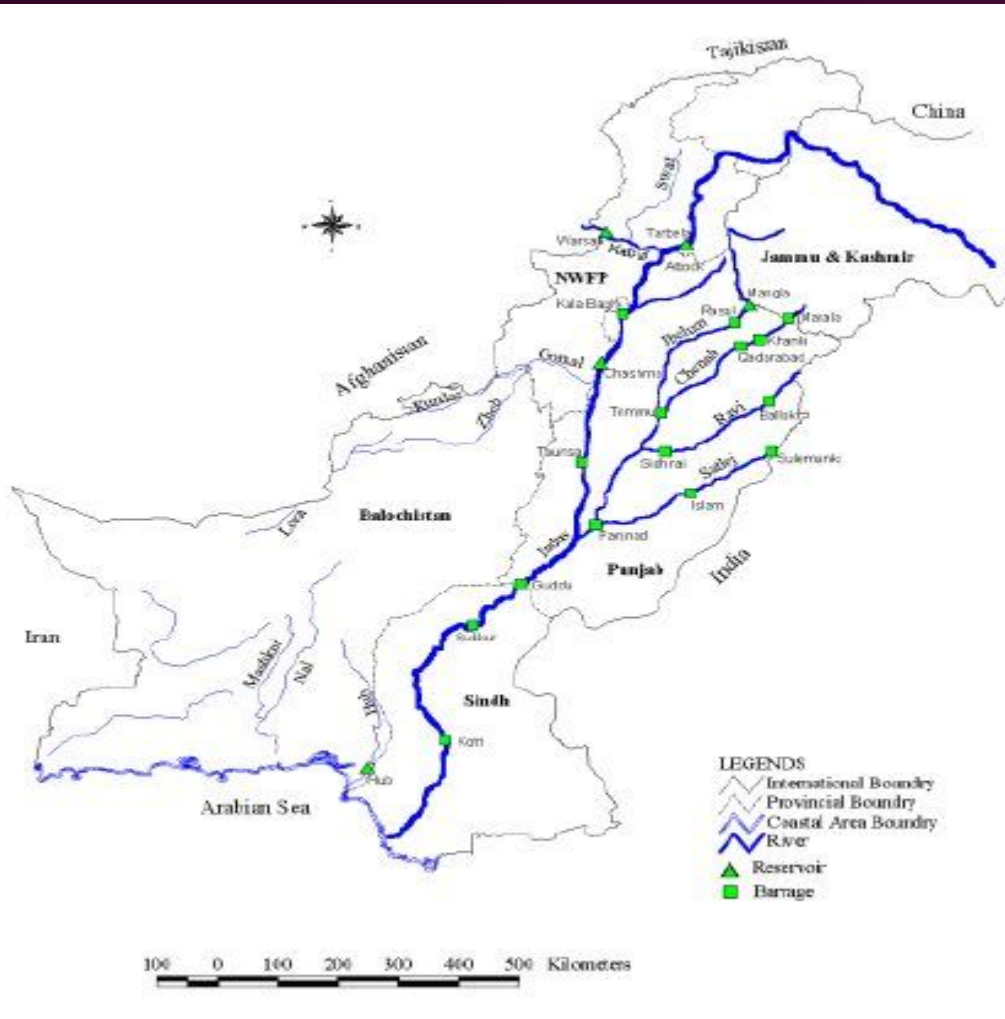
- Historically served as a **buffer state** during the Cold War between Soviet influence in Afghanistan and Western-aligned states.
- Acts as a **frontline state** in the fight against terrorism, especially in the post-9/11 era.

Security and Defense Considerations

- **Eastern Border with India:** The Line of Control (LoC) in Kashmir remains a hotspot, making geography central to Pakistan's defense and strategic calculations.
- **Western Border with Afghanistan:** Porous and mountainous, it poses both opportunities and challenges in terms of security, trade, and migration.

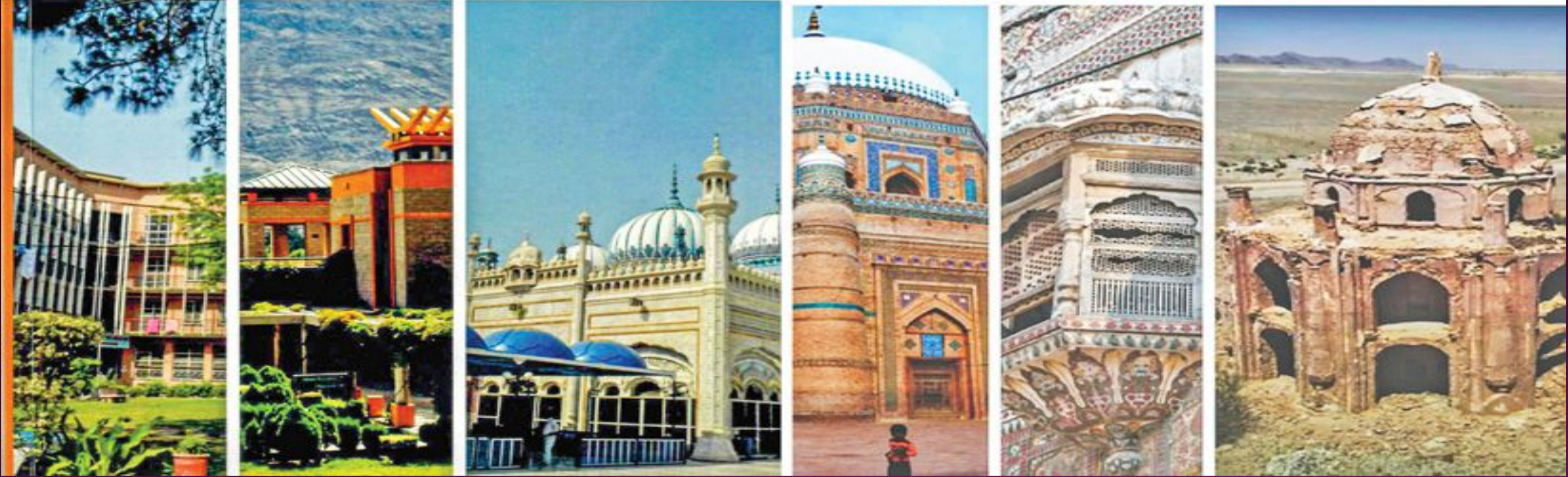


Agricultural Significance



- The Indus River System supports one of the largest irrigation networks in the world, making Pakistan's plains fertile and agriculturally productive.
- Geography heavily influences the economy, with agriculture being a significant sector due to the river-based ecosystem.

Cultural and Historical Crossroads



- Historically a passageway for **invading empires**, traders, and cultural exchanges (e.g., Alexander the Great, the Mughals, Silk Road trade).
- This gives Pakistan a rich cultural heritage and diverse population shaped by centuries of movement and interaction.

Geo politics???

- The impact created by a country on other neighbouring countries due to its geopolitical position is called geopolitics.
- This impact also affects the politics of the region as a whole.

Pakistan's Location on map

Pakistan has a significant geopolitical position.

This part of continent has always been apple of eye for superpowers like U.S.A.(US war against terrorism), Great Britain and USSR(during soviet cold war).

Pakistan is bordered by countries like China, India and Iran and Afghanistan.

Indo-Pak Neighbourhood

Independence of Pakistan in 1947

Relations between India and Pakistan gone through many ups and down.

Firstly: On the distribution of asserts

Secondly: Muslim majority areas were allotted to India.

Resulted into wars, conflicts and military standoffs.

Indo-Pak Wars

Indo-Pakistani War of 1947
Indo-Pakistani War of
1947–1948

1947

Indo-Pakistani War of 1971
Indo-Pakistani War of
1971 and Bangladesh Liberation
War

1971

1965

Indo-Pakistani War of 1965
Indo-Pakistani War of 1965

1999

Indo-Pakistani War of 1999
Kargil War

Indo–Pakistan Wars & Limited Conflicts (1947–2025)

Year(s)	Conflict / Event	Nature	Main Cause	Outcome / Status
1947–1948	First Kashmir War	Full-scale war	Accession of Jammu & Kashmir	UN ceasefire; Kashmir divided along LoC
1965	Second Indo–Pakistan War	Full-scale war	Kashmir dispute; Operation Gibraltar	Tashkent Agreement (1966); status quo
1971	Third Indo–Pakistan War	Full-scale war	East Pakistan crisis; Indian intervention	Creation of Bangladesh; Simla Agreement (1972)

Indo–Pakistan Wars & Limited Conflicts

(1947–2025)

1984–Present	Siachen Conflict	Limited military conflict	Dispute over Siachen Glacier	Indian control; ongoing military deployment
1999	Kargil Conflict	Limited war	Infiltration across LoC	Restoration of LoC; diplomatic fallout
2001–2002	Military Standoff	Near-war crisis	Attack on Indian Parliament	Troop mobilization; war avoided
2016	Uri Crisis	Limited conflict	Attack on Indian army base	India claimed surgical strikes; tensions

Indo–Pakistan Wars & Limited Conflicts (1947–2025)

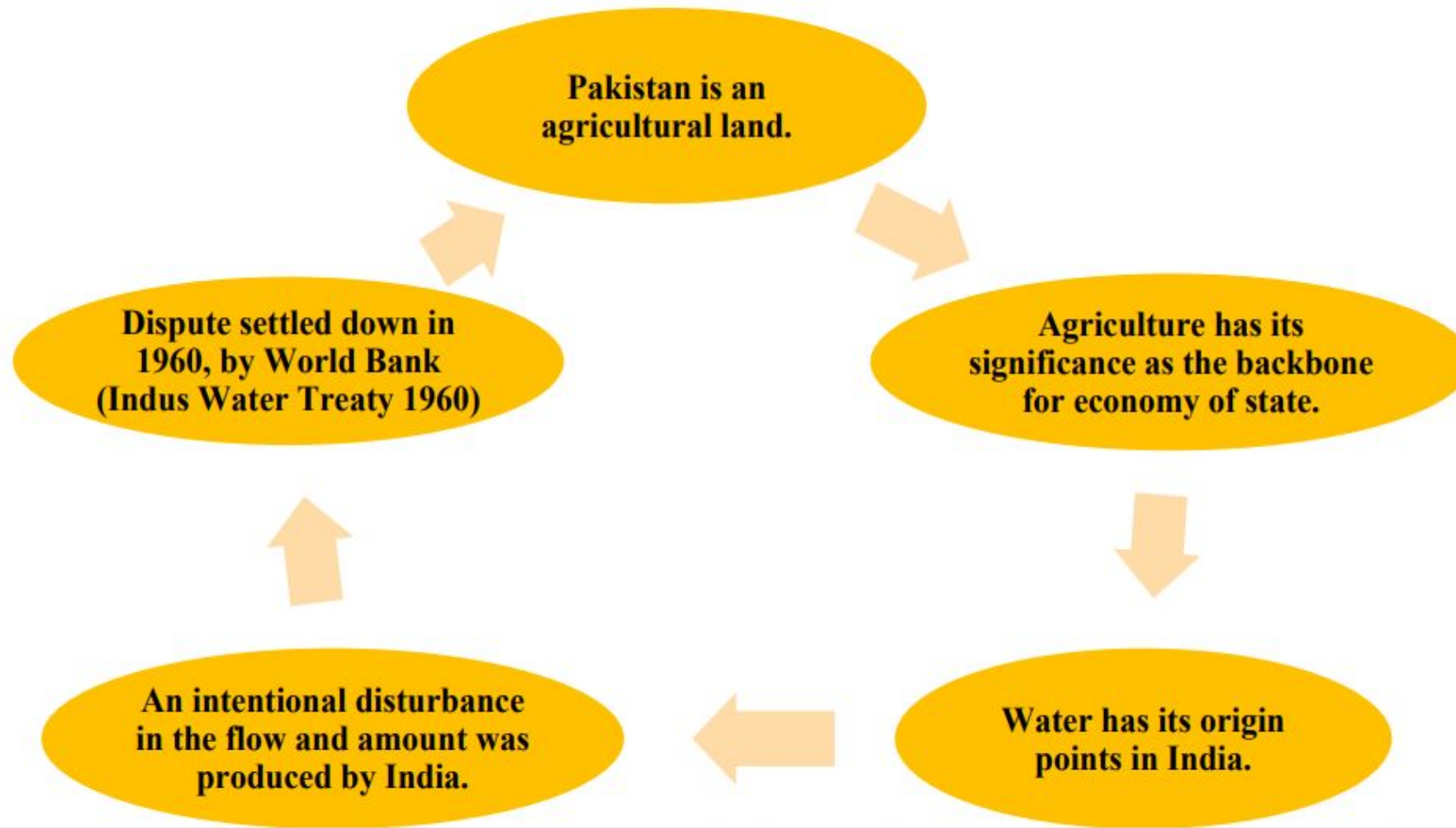
2019	Pulwama–Balakot Crisis	Limited aerial conflict	Pulwama suicide attack	Air engagements; pilot exchange; de-escalation
2020–2024	LoC Ceasefire Violations	Low-intensity conflict	Border firing, political tensions	2021 ceasefire agreement largely held
2025	Indo–Pakistan Crisis (Hybrid & Border Tensions)	Limited / Hybrid conflict	LoC incidents, cyber & information warfare, diplomatic strain	No declared war; tensions managed through diplomacy

Wars: 1947– 48, 1965, 1971

Limited conflicts / crises: 1984, 1999, 2001–02, 2016, 2019, 2025

2025 is NOT a declared war, but is correctly included as a limited / hybrid conflict

Water Issue between India & Pakistan



Bone of contention

At the time of division, Kashmir was a Muslim majority state with a non-Muslim ruler.

He made a deal and gave away the state to India. People of state stood against this injustice and started movement for freedom.

As a result of which, half part of state was taken back by freedom fighters. The rest of state is still Indian Territory.

On 5 August 2019, the government of India revoked the constitutional status of the state of Jammu and Kashmir under Article 370 of the Constitution, and abrogated Article 35A which had allowed it to define who its 'permanent residents' are and what rights and privileges are attached to such residency.

Pak-Iran brother hood

Pakistan relations with Iran were initiated at the time of its independence.

Iran was the very first country to accept Pakistan as newly born Muslim country.

Pakistan warmly welcomed the Islamic revolution in Iran in 1979; Pakistan played its role for stopping the prolonged gulf war in the region.

Free Trade Agreement

Now a days Pakistan and Iran are in strong trading ties.

In 2005, Iran and Pakistan had conducted US\$500 million of trade in electricity and oil.

Iran is extending its railway network towards Tafton.

'The Iran-Pakistan-India pipeline is currently under discussion. It could be a major development between all three nations.

A gas pipe line project is also under discussions between the countries.

As a part of Muslim world, both play their prominent role for the betterment of Muslim umah.

(China) Sino-Pakistan Brotherhood

Chino-Pak brotherhood
needs no words for
explication.

These two neighbours are
very close to each other.

Pakistan and china have
strong relations from
1949.

Since that time, both are
supporting each other in
all aspects.

Pakistan helped china in
being the member of
United Nations.

China's significant moral
and strategic support
played important role
during the wars of 1965
and 1971.

One of the cogent
evidences of Chino-Pak
friendship is Karakorum
highway.

Now China is providing
technical aid to Pakistan in
establishing the Gawadar
port, an international hub
for trade.

(China) Sino-Pakistan Brotherhood

Gawadar has become a key point in settling the economy of Pakistan.

It has greatly enhanced the importance of Pakistan in the era.

This project is being completed by both china and Pakistan and an evidence of chino-Pak brotherhood.

It will bring a revolution in trade after being operational. Not only Pakistan but the entire region will be among its beneficiaries.

Gawadar port will prove itself as backbone in the economy of Pakistan. As well as it will lessen the burden on Port Qasim.

Pakistan's relations with gulf region are also nearly based upon Gawadar port.

Pak-afghan ties

Pakistan shares its long boundary with Afghanistan.

Afghanistan is a Muslim country which has been in state of war from several decades.

Pakistan, being the nearer Muslim nation has always been playing its role for establishing peace in Afghanistan. During soviet cold war, Pakistan helped afghan Muslim government to get rid from USSR.

After the 9/11 attacks, Pakistan joined hands with all world and played eminent part in US war against terrorism. Pakistan provided its army bases and land routes for supplying goods.

In consequences of that, the number of terrorist activities in Pakistan enhanced greatly and Pakistan is still suffering from internal problems.

Another major issue is the sprouting traffic of drugs. This is the source of finance for the militants too.

Both countries are trying to solve these security issues.

Arabian sea

Pakistan shares one of its borders with Arabian Sea which is of high importance.

It plays an important role for the economy of state because Pakistan makes its level best merchandizes through water.

Pak-Russia relations

Pakistan is always eager to keep friendly relations with the nations all over the world.

In 1950, Pakistan preferred America over Russia.

In 1949, Soviet Union sent an invitation to Prime Minister Liaquat Ali Khan to visit the country, followed by the U.S. invitation.

In May 1950, Prime Minister Ali Khan paid a state visit to the United States after being persuaded to snap ties with the Soviet Union,

During soviet war, Pakistan stood with Afghanistan and assisted America in casting out USSR.

Now days both countries are willing to cooperate with each other in the field of commerce and industry.

Russia has no access to warm waters so it seeks alternate routes for trading.

Most nearest water route is through Pakistan so it needs Pakistan for its trade. This is the key of Pak Russia relations.

Pak-American relationships



CONCLUSION

Pakistan's defense relations with major powers show a great deal of pragmatic maneuvering, with a view to achieving its national interests in a sea of partisanship, regional alliances, and diplomatic chicanery. Pakistan, in its early days, entered into partnerships to thwart threats from its eastern neighbor. A singular focus on dealing with India meant that the nature of its defense relations were decidedly narrow and dependent upon how other countries dealt with the latter. That said, Pakistan's focus on broadening the framework of national security and leveraging its geoeconomic power augurs well for the future of the country's defense relations with important regional and global actors, especially because defense procurements as well as a country's ability to become a defense supplier hinge upon its economic capacity. Thus, Pakistan's economic and military diplomacy will be critical to making it a very potent, reliable defense partner. Absent a strategic transformation of its economy, Pakistan would not be able to establish defense relations of a strategic nature, and, in the process, lose a chance to influence major powers. Also, one of the foci of the Government of Pakistan should be to expand its indigenous defense industrial base.